THE VOW FACTOR

Besides the freebies, the BJP is banking on the 'double engine' promise to carry them across the line. But the Congress's anti-corruption push could trip them

BJP

PROMISES

- 'Double engine' is the main poll plank, showcasing flagship schemes like PM Kisan Samman Nidhi (where the central government transfers Rs 6,000 per year to farmers and the state contributes another Rs 4,000) and Jal Jeevan Mission under which 4 million families have got access to tap water
- Connectivity and infrastructure via new highways, trains, airports
- Welfare schemes for farmers include Raitha Vidya Nidhi scholarships for their children; agriculture subsidies
- Women empowerment schemes like Grihini Shakthi offering Rs 1,000 monthly assistance to landless women farm labourers; free bus passes to working women and students
- 'Double engine' schemes have covered over 50 million beneficiaries, says the party
- The party is also banking on its decisions to increase SC/ST reservation by 6 per cent and OBC reservation for Veerashaiva-Lingayats and Vokkaligas by 2 per cent each, though yet to pass the court's test

STRENGTHS

- Popularity of PM Modi
- Organisational network
- Door-to-door campaign

WEAKNESSES

- Corruption allegations
- Exodus of leaders
- Poor footprint in Old Mysuru region

CONGRESS

PROMISES

- Price rise and corruption are the two main campaign issues. It is highlighting the charges of '40 per cent' commission raised by contractors, irregularities in recruitment for police sub-inspectors and the Lokayukta case against sitting BJP MLA K. Madalu Virupakshappa whose son was trapped in March while accepting a bribe
- Unemployment, filling up of government vacancies and local issues are the other main themes
- Corruption-free government
- Four guarantees: free electricity of up to 200 units for every household; Rs 2,000 monthly allowance for every woman who is head of her family; doubling the free distribution of rice for BPL families to 10 kg; monthly allowances of Rs 3,000 for unemployed graduates and Rs 1,500 for diploma-holders for a two-year period
- Review of the reservations issue, says the BJP government's quota increases are only on paper and won't stand legal scrutiny

STRENGTHS

- Anti-incumbency factor
- Rejuvenated party network
- Broad-based vote share across Karnataka

WEAKNESSES

- Missteps in ticket distribution
- Triangular fights
- Competing ambitions of party's big leaders

JD(S)



PROMISES

- Poll campaign built around five themes, the pancharathna. These are affordable education, health, agriculture, employment and housing
- Five free cooking gas cylinders a year; loan waiver for women's groups; Rs 6,000 allowance for pregnant women for six months
- Reservation for Kannadigas in private sector establishments
- Free bicycles to 680,000 high school students; electric mopeds for 60,000 college-going girls from financially weaker families
- Financial aid for farmers up to Rs 10,000 per acre; monthly aid of Rs 2,000 for families of farm workers
- Wage revision for police force
- Pension hike for widows to Rs 2,500 and physically handicapped people to Rs 2,500; Rs 5,000 monthly allowance for senior citizens; increase in honorarium for anganwadi workers to Rs 5,000; stipend of Rs 8,000 for youth doing one-year skill training programmes
- Implementation of Sachar Committee report

STRENGTHS

- Strong presence in Old Mysuru region
- Tickets given to rebels from rival parties
- Can create hung assembly

WEAKNESSES

- Over-reliance on Deve Gowda family
- Defections of local leaders
- Faces two big rivals